

Non-Dual Awareness: A Recognition

Essence of Yellamrajugaru's Teaching

A Note Before You Read

Advaita is not a philosophy to believe in. It is a way of seeing.

It does not ask you to accept something on faith. It asks you to look carefully at your own experience and notice what is always present in it. When you do, you find that pure awareness is the fundamental reality. Everything else, every object, every thought, every experience, is a superimposition (*Abhasa*) upon that awareness.

What follows is a teaching that makes this clear, step by step. It moves through three levels. First, the abstract principle. Then, a familiar illustration. And finally, the real application to your own direct experience.

The goal is recognition (*Pratyabhijna*). Not arriving at a new state, but recognizing what has always been the case.

1. The Principle (*Siddhantam*)

Before looking at any example, the teaching first lays out a universal logic. In any situation where there is a common underlying reality and many forms appearing within it, these ten relationships always hold.

The underlying reality is called the Universal (*Samanyam*). The forms appearing within it are called Particulars (*Visheshams*).

Allied pairs of terms (*paryaya padalu*) describe this same relationship from different angles: *Anvaya* and *Vyatireka* (what persists and what varies), *Anuvrutti* and *Vyavrutti* (what continues and what is excluded), *Adhyaropa* and *Apavada* (what is superimposed and what negates it). All of them point to the one underlying relationship between the real and its appearance.

#	The Universal (<i>Samanyam</i>)	The Particulars (<i>Visheshams</i>)
1	The Universal is one .	The Particulars are many .
2	All Particulars arise from the Universal.	The Universal does not arise from Particulars.
3	The Universal pervades all Particulars equally. That is why it is called <i>Samanyam</i> (the common element).	Particulars cannot pervade each other, nor can they pervade the Universal.
4	Without the Universal, Particulars cannot exist.	Without Particulars, the Universal still exists.
5	The existence of the Universal is the existence of the Particulars.	Particulars have no independent existence of their own.
6	Therefore, the Universal alone is real.	Particulars are not real in themselves.
7	The Universal is the substance (<i>Svarupam</i>).	Particulars are its superimposition, its appearance (<i>Abhasa</i>).
8	The Universal remains as itself.	That same Universal appears as the Particulars.
9	The Universal is indestructible. It is eternal.	Particulars are always subject to destruction.
10	Recognizing the Universal within every Particular is called Recognition (<i>Pratyabhijna</i>). When you keep recognizing it, Particulars no longer appear foreign to the Universal. They appear as its own nature. This is called Resolution (<i>Pravilapanam</i>).	

This is the abstract structure. Now the teaching brings it to life with a familiar example.

2. The Illustration (*Drishtantam*)

Take gold and ornaments. A single piece of gold can be shaped into rings, bangles, chains, necklaces. The gold is the Universal (*Samanyam*). The ornaments are the Particulars (*Visheshams*). Watch how the same ten-point logic applies exactly.

#	Gold (<i>Suvarnam</i>)	Ornaments (<i>Abharanalu</i>)
1	Gold is one .	Ornaments are many .
2	All ornaments come from gold.	Gold does not come from ornaments.
3	Gold pervades every ornament, inside and outside.	One ornament cannot pervade another, nor can it pervade the whole gold.
4	Remove gold and no ornament can exist.	Remove ornaments and gold still exists.
5	The existence of gold is the existence of the ornaments.	Ornaments have no independent existence apart from gold.
6	Therefore, what truly exists is only gold.	Ornaments are not real in themselves.
7	Gold is the substance (<i>Svarupam</i>).	Ornaments are its superimposition, its appearance (<i>Abhasa</i>).
8	Gold remains as gold.	That same gold appears as ornaments.
9	Gold is indestructible (as a substance).	Ornaments can always be melted down or broken.
10	Recognizing gold in every ornament is Pratyabhijna . When you keep recognizing it, no ornament appears as something other than gold. They are not alien to it. They are of the same nature. This is Pravilaapanam .	

This makes the logic tangible. But this is still only an illustration. The real application follows next, and it changes something fundamental.

3. The Real Application (*Draashtaantikam*)

Now the teaching turns to what it is really about.

Pure awareness is the fundamental reality. The teaching calls this *Sphurana*, the bare sense of “I exist,” the simple fact of being aware. This is the Universal (*Samanyam*). This is the Self (*Atma*).

Everything that appears within this awareness, from your own mind to the farthest reaches of space, is the Particular (*Vishesham*). This is the not-self (*Anatma*).

Just as friendship is one but friends are many, awareness is one but the objects appearing in it are many.

#	Awareness (<i>Sphurana</i> / <i>Atma</i>)	The World (<i>Anatma</i>)
1	Awareness is one .	The objects appearing within it are many .
2	From awareness alone, all animate and inanimate things arise.	From things, awareness does not arise.
3	The existence of awareness pervades all things. Things cannot pervade each other, nor can they pervade awareness.	Things have no independent existence.
4	Without awareness, there is no world.	Without the world, awareness still exists by itself.
5	The existence of awareness is the existence of the world.	The world has no independent existence of its own.
6	Awareness alone truly exists.	The appearing world does not truly exist on its own.
7	Awareness is the substance (<i>Svarupam</i>).	The appearing world is its superimposition (<i>Abhasa</i>).
8	Awareness remains as awareness.	It appears as the world.
9	Awareness is indestructible. It is self-evident (<i>Svatah Pramanam</i>).	The world is always subject to destruction, being an object of knowledge (<i>Prameyam</i>).
10	Recognizing the existence (<i>Asti-Bhati</i>) of awareness in every single object, from your own body to the entire universe, is Pratyabhijna . When you keep recognizing it, the entire <i>Anatma</i> world no longer appears as something foreign to you. It appears as your own nature, your own expression (<i>Vibhuti</i>). This is Pravilaapanam . Both together, the Self and its expression becoming one, is what the Advaitins call Sarvatma Bhavam : the vision of the Self in all.	

4. Where the Illustration Ends and the Real Seeing Begins

The three tables above follow the same logic. But there is a crucial difference between the illustration and the real application. Yellamrajugaru calls these the **Turning Points**, and they are the heart of the teaching.

In the gold illustration, both gold and ornaments are visible objects. You can see gold. You can see a bangle. Both are out there, available to your eyes and hands.

But in reality, awareness is not an object. The Universal here is not something “out there” that you can look at. The Universal is *you*. It is your own awareness, the one who is doing the seeing. It is the Subject, not an object.

This is the key shift. In the illustration, both columns of the table are objects. In the real application, the left column (awareness) is the Subject and the right column (the world) is the object.

First: objects are visible, but their existence is not.

Look at any object. A cup, a tree, a person. You can see its shape, its color, its form. These are its names and forms, and they are visible. But now ask: can you see the fact that it exists? You cannot. The “being there” of anything is never something you can point to or photograph. You see the cup and you *know* it is there. The knowing is not coming from your eyes. It is coming from awareness. So every object has a visible part (its name and form) and an invisible part (its existence). The visible part you see. The invisible part you only know.

Second: that invisible existence and invisible awareness are not two separate things.

When you say “the cup exists,” what is actually happening? You are aware of the cup. The cup’s existence and your awareness of it are not two different invisible things sitting side by side. They are one and the same. Yellamrajugaru calls this the secret (*Rahasyam*): invisible awareness (*Eruka, Chit*) and invisible existence (*Uniki, Sat*), these two together are what we call the Self (*Atma*).

Third: why can you never see them? Because they are not objects. They are you.

Existence and awareness are not invisible the way a hidden object is invisible. They are invisible because they are not objects at all. They are on the side of the seer, not the seen. The eye can see everything in the room but it can never see itself. Not because it is hidden, but because it is the one doing the seeing. In the same way, awareness can know every object but can never become an object of knowing. And that awareness, that existence, is what you call “I.” It is not something far away. It is what you already are.

Pure awareness by itself has no problem. Objects by themselves have no problem.

The problem arises only when awareness gets knotted (*Granthi*) with a particular object, when it identifies with the body and says “I am this body.” That knot is called *Dehatma Abhimanam*, the identification of the Self with the body. The being who lives in that knot is the *Jeevu*, the individual who experiences limitation, birth, and death.

The teaching does not ask you to destroy the world or escape from it. It asks you to **untie the knot** by recognizing that the awareness which seems trapped in one body is actually the awareness that pervades everything.

5. Living with This Recognition

The practice (*Sadhana*) is simply this:

In every object you encounter, from your own body to the world around you, recognize that what truly exists in it is awareness alone. The names and forms are its superimposition (*Abhasa*). The substance (*Svarupam*) is awareness. This recognition is *Pratyabhijna*.

As you keep recognizing this, something shifts. The world stops appearing as something separate from you, something foreign. It begins to appear as your own nature, your own expression (*Vibhuti*). Nothing is alien. Everything is of the same nature as your Self. This is *Pravilaa-panam*.

Pratyabhijna and *Pravilaapanam* together are **Sarvatma Bhavam**, the non-dual vision. Not a mystical experience that comes and goes, but a clear seeing that, once recognized, is simply what is.

This is what the Advaitins call *Advaita Darshanam*. And in this seeing, all questions of birth, death, and limitation find their complete resolution.

This recognition is an inner seeing. It is not something to announce or prove to anyone. It is not a way to escape from the world, because the teaching itself says the world is your own expression (*Vibhuti*). As long as the aspiration (*Spruha*) to see clearly is alive in you, that is enough. You carry it quietly, in how you look at things, not in what you say about them.

Reference: <https://advaitavedanta.in/>